

Fort Hood PCS Housing Guide

BAH Budget Calculator + Best Neighborhoods by Gate

2026 EDITION | VERIFIED BAH RATES | VA LOAN READY

What's Inside

PCS Timeline Checklist

120 days out to closing day -- every step mapped

BAH Budget Calculator

Your rank = your max purchase price. The exact math.

Neighborhoods by Gate

Killeen, Harker Heights, Nolanville, Belton, Temple -- by commute

Rent vs Buy Decision

The honest math for 2-year, 3-year, and career tours

VA Loan Quick Facts

0% down, no PMI, and what nobody tells you about the funding fee

Military Appreciation Credit

Commission rebate at closing for active duty and veterans

Taylor Dasch | EG Realty

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\$27M+ in volume | 100+ transactions | 3-Year BiggerPockets Featured Agent

PCS Timeline Checklist

FROM ORDERS TO KEYS

120+ DAYS OUT

Orders Received

- > Request VA Certificate of Eligibility (eBenefits -- takes 24-48 hours)
- > Get VA pre-approval from a military-friendly lender (NOT your bank)
- > Call Taylor: 254-718-4249 -- I'll set up your search based on BAH + rank
- > Start remote neighborhood tours via video call if you can't visit yet
- > Research school districts: Belton ISD (rated higher) vs Killeen ISD vs Temple ISD

90 DAYS OUT

Home Search Active

- > Narrow to 2-3 neighborhoods based on gate proximity + BAH budget
- > Schedule HHT (House Hunting Trip) if your unit authorizes it
- > Review listings daily -- I'll send matches that fit your BAH range
- > If buying: lock in rate when you find the home (rates change weekly)
- > If renting: sign lease, set move-in date -- skip to move-in checklist

60 DAYS OUT

Under Contract

- > Submit offer -- VA allows seller to pay up to 4% of your closing costs
- > Order VA appraisal (\$500-600) -- required, non-negotiable
- > Schedule home inspection (\$400-500) -- I'll recommend inspectors
- > Get homeowner's insurance quotes (required before closing)
- > Send contract to your lender -- clock starts on underwriting

30 DAYS OUT

Closing Prep

- > Clear any underwriting conditions (lender will ask for documents)
- > Schedule final walkthrough (24-48 hours before closing)
- > Confirm closing date with title company
- > Set up utilities: water, electric, internet (Temple has municipal water)
- > Arrange movers or DITY/PPM move -- file with transportation office

CLOSING DAY

Keys In Hand

- > Sign closing documents (bring military ID + orders)
- > VA funding fee rolls into loan unless disability exempt
- > Get keys same day -- you're home
- > File for homestead exemption ASAP (\$100K off school taxes in TX)
- > Update DEERS and vehicle registration to new address

PRO TIP:

Start your VA pre-approval BEFORE your HHT. Sellers take pre-approved VA buyers seriously.

Most families close in 30-45 days from offer. I handle the timeline so you focus on your PCS.

BAH Budget Calculator

2026 FORT HOOD BAH RATES | YOUR RANK = YOUR BUDGET

Your Basic Allowance for Housing (BAH) is based on rank, dependency status, and duty station ZIP. Below are the 2026 Fort Hood rates and the max VA purchase price each BAH supports. Math: BAH covers PITI at 7% rate, 30-year term, 2.3% tax rate, \$150/mo insurance.

RANK	W/ DEP	W/O DEP	MAX VA PRICE	MONTHLY PITI	CUSHION
E-1 to E-4	\$1,662	\$1,344	\$179,000	\$1,580	+\$82
E-5	\$1,695	\$1,371	\$183,000	\$1,615	+\$80
E-6	\$1,920	\$1,554	\$210,000	\$1,840	+\$80
E-7	\$2,070	\$1,680	\$228,000	\$1,990	+\$80
E-8	\$2,190	\$1,776	\$242,000	\$2,110	+\$80
E-9	\$2,310	\$1,869	\$258,000	\$2,240	+\$70
W-1	\$1,890	\$1,530	\$206,000	\$1,810	+\$80
W-2	\$2,040	\$1,653	\$224,000	\$1,960	+\$80
W-3	\$2,190	\$1,776	\$242,000	\$2,110	+\$80
W-4	\$2,370	\$1,920	\$265,000	\$2,295	+\$75
W-5	\$2,520	\$2,040	\$283,000	\$2,440	+\$80
O-1	\$1,770	\$1,434	\$192,000	\$1,690	+\$80
O-2	\$2,010	\$1,626	\$220,000	\$1,930	+\$80
O-3	\$2,340	\$1,893	\$260,000	\$2,265	+\$75
O-4	\$2,577	\$2,088	\$288,000	\$2,500	+\$77
O-5	\$2,760	\$2,235	\$310,000	\$2,680	+\$80
O-6	\$2,940	\$2,382	\$332,000	\$2,860	+\$80
O-7+	\$3,090	\$2,505	\$350,000	\$3,010	+\$80

HOW TO READ THIS TABLE:

Find your rank. The "Max VA Price" column is the most expensive home your BAH fully covers with \$0 out of pocket per month. The "Cushion" is what's left after PITI for utilities and maintenance. Want a pricier home? You pay the difference monthly.

DISABILITY WAIVER:

Any VA disability rating = funding fee WAIVED. Saves you \$3,800-\$7,500 at closing.

Neighborhoods by Gate

WHERE TO LIVE BASED ON YOUR COMMUTE

KILLEEN

Main Gate (T.J. Mills Blvd)

10-20 min to Main Gate

\$150K-\$280K

Killeen ISD

Closest to post. Most military families live here. Highest selection of BAH-friendly homes under \$230K. Neighborhoods range from older established to newer builds off Stan Schlueter Loop.

Best for: E-1 through E-7 who want shortest commute and lowest cost

Watch out: Higher crime pockets in older areas -- ask me which streets to avoid

HARKER HEIGHTS

Clear Creek Gate (East Side)

15-25 min to Clear Creek

\$200K-\$350K

Killeen ISD

The upgrade from Killeen without going far. Better neighborhoods, newer builds, more retail. Tuscany Meadows, Purser Crossing, and Dana Peak are popular. Still Killeen ISD but in the better-rated schools.

Best for: E-6+ and junior officers who want better neighborhoods but quick gate access

Watch out: Still Killeen ISD -- if Belton ISD matters, keep reading

NOLANVILLE

Clear Creek Gate

15-20 min to Clear Creek

\$220K-\$320K

Belton ISD

Small-town feel with Belton ISD schools. Popular with families who want the school upgrade without the Temple price premium. Newer subdivisions going up. Good middle ground between gate access and quality of life.

Best for: Families prioritizing Belton ISD on an NCO budget

Watch out: Limited retail -- you will drive to Harker Heights or Belton for groceries/dining

Neighborhoods by Gate (continued)

BELTON

Clear Creek Gate

20-30 min to Clear Creek

\$220K-\$400K

Belton ISD

Best schools in the area (Belton ISD, TEA Grade B). More established neighborhoods with character. Lake Belton access for recreation. Slightly longer commute but families consistently say the schools are worth it.

Best for: Officers and senior NCOs who prioritize schools above commute

Watch out: 25-30 min to gate in morning traffic -- budget your drive time

TEMPLE

Any Gate (furthest)

30-40 min to Main Gate

\$180K-\$750K+

Temple ISD / Belton ISD

Best value per square foot in the region. Wider price range, more architectural variety. If your spouse works at Baylor Scott & White, Temple cuts THEIR commute to 5 minutes. Neighborhoods like Canyon Creek and Legacy Ranch compete with anything in Central TX.

Best for: Dual-military or military + BSW spouse. Career military planning to stay.

Watch out: Longest Fort Hood commute. Only works if gate time is not your top priority.

Rent vs Buy: The Honest Math

YOUR TOUR LENGTH DETERMINES THE ANSWER

UNDER 2 YEARS

RENT

Closing costs + selling costs eat your equity.
Renting is almost always smarter for short tours.

2-3 YEARS

ANALYZE

It depends on price point, appreciation, and whether you would keep it as a rental. Run the numbers.

3+ YEARS

CONSIDER BUYING

You build real equity, lock in housing cost, and can keep it as a rental when you PCS.

EXAMPLE: E-6 WITH DEPENDENTS | 3-YEAR TOUR | \$210K HOME

BAH: \$1,920/mo | PITI: ~\$1,840/mo | Monthly surplus: \$80

3-year equity built: ~\$12,400 | 3-year appreciation (3%): ~\$19,300

Total position after 3 years: +\$31,700 in equity vs \$0 from renting. At PCS: sell or keep as rental.

VA Loan: What Makes It Different

THE BEST HOME LOAN IN AMERICA -- AND IT'S YOURS

0% Down Payment

No down payment required. Period. Your service IS your down payment.

No PMI

Conventional loans charge \$100-300/mo for PMI under 20% down. VA: \$0.

2.15% Funding Fee

One-time fee (rolls into loan). First use: 2.15%. Subsequent: 3.3%.

Seller Pays 4%

Seller concessions up to 4% of purchase price -- covers closing costs.

Disability Waiver

Any VA disability rating = funding fee WAIVED. Saves \$3,800-\$7,500.

No Loan Limit

Full entitlement = no VA loan limit. Buy above the conforming limit.

Reusable Benefit

Use VA loan benefits multiple times. Sell, restore entitlement, repeat.

Assumable Loan

VA loans are assumable -- a future buyer can take over your rate.

VA vs Conventional at a Glance

	VA LOAN	CONVENTIONAL
Down Payment	\$0	3-20%
PMI	None	\$100-300/mo
Funding Fee	2.15% (waivable)	None
Seller Concessions	Up to 4%	Up to 3%
Credit Score	580-620 typical	620-680 typical
Loan Limit	None (full entitlement)	\$766,550
Assumable?	Yes	No

Military Appreciation Credit

When you buy or sell with me, active duty service members and veterans receive a commission credit at closing. No strings, no catch. Your service saved me the marketing cost of finding you -- I pass that savings back.

This isn't a slogan. It's money back in your pocket at the closing table.

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Call | Text | DM "PCS"

I'll match your BAH to
the right neighborhood